

RESURRECTION MOMS

* Blue denotes power point slide

* Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: Hebrews 11:32-40 (NKJV) *“What more shall I say? For the time would fail me to tell of Gideon and Barak and Samson and Jephthah, also of David and Samuel and the prophets: ³³ who through faith subdued kingdoms, worked righteousness, obtained promises, stopped the mouths of lions, ³⁴ quenched the violence of fire, escaped the edge of the sword, out of weakness were made strong, became valiant in battle, turned to flight the armies of the aliens. ³⁵ Women received their dead raised to life again. Others were tortured, not accepting deliverance, that they might obtain a better resurrection. ³⁶ Still others had trial of mockings and*

scourgings, yes, and of chains and imprisonment. ³⁷ They were stoned, they were sawn in two, were tempted,^[f] were slain with the sword. They wandered about in sheepskins and goatskins, being destitute, afflicted, tormented— ³⁸ of whom the world was not worthy. They wandered in deserts and mountains, in dens and caves of the earth. ³⁹ And all these, having obtained a good testimony through faith, did not receive the promise, ⁴⁰ God having provided something better for us, that they should not be made perfect apart from us.”

INTRO: My favorite chapter in the Bible is Hebrews eleven. In this noted Bible chapter, the author of Hebrews introduces us to an impressive list of heroic figures from the Old Testament. These are remarkable men and women whose stories stand out to encourage and challenge our faith. Some of these heroes of faith are well-known Bible personalities, while others remain somewhat

veiled or altogether anonymous.

This chapter is a star-studded account of the historic heroes of the Christian faith:

- Able...
- Enoch...
- Noah...
- Abraham...
- Sarah...
- Isaac...
- Jacob...
- Joseph...
- Moses...
- Rahab...

This passage is power packed with people of uncommon faith, culminating in uncommon results. Miracles, signs, and wonders followed them as they chose to believe God for things they could not do on their own.

This pretty much concludes the chapter for

most people and preaching material. In reality the chapter is just heating up.

Hebrews 11:32-35 (KJV) *“And what shall I more say? for the time would fail me to tell of Gedeon, and of Barak, and of Samson, and of Jephthae; of David also, and Samuel, and of the prophets: {33} Who through faith subdued kingdoms, wrought righteousness, obtained promises, stopped the mouths of lions, {34} Quenched the violence of fire, escaped the edge of the sword, out of weakness were made strong, waxed valiant in fight, turned to flight the armies of the aliens. {35} Women received their dead raised to life again: and others were tortured, not accepting deliverance; that they might obtain a better resurrection.”* (LEAVE ON THE

SCREEN FOR FIVE MINUTES) Did you catch that? *“Women received their dead raised to life...”* Have you ever really noticed that before? I had never really paid any attention to it until this week. This is a

very important verse. *“Women receive their dead raised to life.”*

Today I want to talk about Resurrection Moms.

Of all the miracles listed in Hebrews chapter eleven, the greatest miracle of all is the raising of the dead. In this chapter the raising of the dead is mentioned three times:

- Enoch cheated death... (Vs 5)
- Abraham considered Isaac as good as dead... (Vs 19)
- Women received their dead raised to life... (Vs 35)

There are three resurrection moms mentioned in the Bible.

THE SHUNAMMITE WOMAN: (2 Kings 4)

This woman and her husband built a prophet's chamber for Elisha so that when

he was passing through Shunem he could rest at this home away from home. The level of respect this family displayed toward the man of God and the ministry he was involved in can only be appraised by the effort and expense they went to in order to make the man of God feel comfortable.

In an effort to repay the widow for her kindness, Elisha asks the lady of the house what he could do for her. He discovered that she was barren and desperately wanted a child despite the fact that her husband was old and incapable of producing children. The man of God prophesied over her, that she would have a son within a year. Just as he prophesied, miraculously the couple gave birth to a little boy in less than a year.

When the child was a few years old he was in the field with his father and was struck with a heat stroke or an aneurism. The child did not survive.

The Shunammite woman did not go into hysterics; she sprang into action. She placed her son in the prophet's chamber, prepared a chariot pulled by her fastest horses, and told the servant to ride at top speed unless she told him differently. Make no mistake about it this was one determined mom! Anthony Robbins said, *“Determination is the wakeup call to the human will.”* **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

If you want to survive, never step between a mom and her child who is in distress.

The Shunammite woman sought out the man of God in an expectation of the child's life being restored. When Gehazi went out to meet the Shunammite woman he asked *“Is it well with you? Is it well with your son? Is it well with your husband?”* Notice her answer, *“It is well.”* This is an incredible statement of faith, and I ask all moms this

morning, what are you willing to do to rescue your child?

Are you kidding me? Her son is lying on a bed at her home and he is dead. ***“It is well!”*** What kind of response is that? It was far from well, the boy was dead!

In her mind this resurrection mom was not about to take no for an answer! She never considered settling for anything but a resurrection! Anthony Robbins said, *“We must remember that one determined person can make a significant difference, and that a small group of determined people can change the course of history.”* **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

Some of the moms in this room need to bow up against the enemy who is bent on the destruction of your children and say, ***“It is well with my family!”*** I call on the resurrection moms in this house to start

“Calling those things that are not as though they were.”

Elisha was going to send his servant Gehazi to tend to the child, but this resurrection mom was having none of it. She insisted that Elisha accompany her back to her home to pray for her son.

Never underestimate the tenacity of a mom whose child is in imminent danger. Agatha Christie said, *“A mother’s love for her child is like nothing else in the world. It knows no law, no pity. It dares all things and crushes down remorsefully all that stands in its path.”* **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN FOR UNTIL I START TALKING ABOUT THE WIDOW OF NAIN)**

When Elisha arrived at the widow’s house, he found the boy on Elisha’s bed in the prophet’s chamber and he stretched himself out on the child and the child came back to

life.

The Shunammite woman could have accepted the fate of death for her son and said this is just a part of life. She did nothing of the sort, and I want to remind the moms in the room today that you do not have to accept the story the enemy has written for your children.

Gather your faith and believe God to help you become a resurrection mom. The devil may have told you that your child is never going to serve God but you need to declare a holy war on the devil in your child's life right here and right now!

THE WIDOW OF NAIN: (Luke 7)

The widow of Nain is very different from the Shunammite woman, yet she stepped into the path of greatness when she met Jesus. As a result of a chance encounter with Jesus she became one-of-three resurrection

moms in Scripture.

What we do not know about this situation:

- We have no record of the child's birth...
- We do not have any proof of a prior relationship between Jesus and this woman...
- We have no information regarding the cause of death...

What we do know:

- The young man was dead...
- The mother was a widow...
- Jesus was moved with compassion...
- Jesus stopped the funeral procession...
- Jesus raised the dead man to life...
- The dead man sat up...
- The dead man began to speak...

The widow of Nain was beyond hope where her son was concerned but Jesus turned a hopeless funeral procession into a celebration of life.

I have a word for some resurrection Moms in this house today, *“Don’t give up, God is about to show up and show out in your family.”* **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN FOR FIVE MINUTES)**

MARY THE MOTHER OF JESUS:

Though we do not worship Mary, she is a central figure in the story of God incarnate, the earthly life of Jesus.

Think of it:

- She was open to the idea of the virgin birth...
- She endured enormous ridicule so that the purpose of God could be carried out...
- She kept a scrapbook of the newspaper clippings and the miracles her son performed...
- She watched as her son was brutally beaten, publicly mocked, and hung until

dead...

- She was in the cemetery as one of the first witnesses of the resurrection...

Can you imagine the thrill of excitement as reality began to sink in for Mary as she stood in that cemetery contemplating what might have happened to the body of her dead son?

She began to remember all His words:
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- *“I will be betrayed in Jerusalem, but I will rise again on the third day.”*
- *“The son of man will suffer many things, be rejected by the elders, the chief priest, and the teachers of the law. They will kill me but I will rise again on the third day.”*
- *“The Son of Man is going to be delivered into the hands of men. They will kill him, and after three days he*

will rise.”

- *“I will destroy this temple and build it again in three day’s.”*

The truth of His resurrection began to cascade over Mary as she took her rightful place with the other two-resurrection moms in Scripture. Her son was dead but had come back to life! What joy! What celebration as she began to realize that her son who had been dead for three day’s was now alive!

CONCLUSION:

Today I believe many other moms are going to leave this place having joined the ranks of resurrection moms.

(Story of the prodigal son)

Notice several things:

- The son forsook the good life... *“Give me what belongs to me...”*
- The son squandered everything... *“Spent everything on wasteful*

living...

- The son was destitute... *“He was eating the husks from the corn he was feeding to the pigs...”*
- The son recognized his condition... *“It is better to be a servant of my father than to be here...”*
- The son took a chance on the father and home... *“I will arise and go to the father’s house...”*
- The father was patiently awaiting his return... *“When he was yet a great way off the father ran toward him...”*
- The father was welcoming, not judgmental... *“But the father said to his servants, ‘Bring out the best robe and put it on him, and put a ring on his hand and sandals on his feet.’²³ And bring the fatted calf here and kill it, and let us eat and be merry.”*

Listen to the words of the prodigal son’s Father. [Luke 15:24](#) (KJV) *“For this my son*

was dead, and is alive again; he was lost, and is found.” **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF SERVICE)**

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PLACES PREACHED:

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